

we are convinced that the buying and selling of stocks, bonds, and other evidences of liens and ownerships, is a fundamental business which performs an essential service.

That there is no lack of opportunity for us is demonstrated by the fact that even last year the volume of stocks and bonds bought and sold was more than thirteen billion dollars. Essentially the job before us involves adapting our operations so that expenses will be in ratio to existing minimum standards of gross income; and then increasing the gross income by adapting our policies to meet the standards and requirements of our customers and public opinion. The sooner we recognize that the temper of living may never again be identical with what it was twelve or fifteen years ago, the sooner we shall gear ourselves for success under present and future conditions.

ALL MUST JOIN TO REESTABLISH FAITH

We've got a job to do—we in the security business—a job of reestablishing faith in the security market as a place for sound investment. This job ought to be done by everybody in the business, and we think in time will be. But we are not going to wait for someone else to start it. We're no smarter, or better, than our competitors, and we have no thought whatever of driving anyone out of business. But we do recognize certain fundamental facts that have to be coped with by our business in its relations with the public, and we're going to make a beginning.

We will be delighted to have the cooperation of anyone and everyone else who sees the road ahead as we think we see it. There will be no secrets in our plans or operations. What is true of our needs, we consider to be equally true of others having a direct or indirect stake in the business—our competitors, banks, insurance companies, etc. So it will be our purpose to cooperate with everyone who wants to bend